

THE ELON GAZETTE

Weekday briefing on what Elon Musk is saying and doing

THURSDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2026

THE MORNING PICTURE

Starlink's India fight, a Grok Bot shopping clerk, and a White House medal

In the day and a half since Wednesday morning EDT, Elon Musk posted about 93 times. The through-line was Starlink: he accused Indian "oligarchs" of blocking a license after five years of compliance, asked whether Mukesh Ambani is "the real boss of India," celebrated Starlink Mobile in Bangladesh, cheered Koninklijke Luchtvaart Maatschappij (KLM) picking Starlink for free intercontinental Wi-Fi, and welcomed Crew-12's Dragon splashdown off Los Angeles. The Federal Communications

Commission (FCC) clearance for 15,000 next-generation direct-to-phone satellites sat under it all.

On the product side, Grok Bot gained a Shopify connector, a promise that simple requests will ride a fast Grok 4.8, and an open router that can call Claude Opus 5.5 and other models. This afternoon, President Donald Trump is set to award Musk the National Medal of Science at the White House "Science: A New Golden Age" summit alongside Sergey Brin, Jensen Huang, and Lisa Su.

I · SPACEX & STARLINK

India's license fight, phones from space, and Crew-12 home

Musk made Starlink's stalled India launch the loudest story of the past day, while Bangladesh went live, KLM booked the constellation for ocean Wi-Fi, and Dragon brought four astronauts home.

15,000 Next-generation Starlink Mobile satellites the FCC approved (Oct 6)	100× Bandwidth Musk says V2 will add over today's ~650 mobile sats	165+ Countries where Starlink is already licensed, per Musk	mid-2027 KLM's start date for free Starlink Wi-Fi on long-haul flights
--	--	---	--

India: oligarchs, Ambani, and the least-served

Quoting a long DogeDesigner thread that said 11,256 Indian villages still lacked 4G as of May and that only 4.26% of Indian internet subscriptions are wired, Musk posted the sharpest line of the day (seen more than 60 million times):

"Unfortunately, we are being blocked by certain oligarchs in order to maintain their monopolistic chokehold on the Indian people. You can guess who they are ... This is a crime against the people of India!"

ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · POST

CNBC notes that Reliance chairman Mukesh Ambani's Jio and Sunil Mittal's Airtel together hold more than 80% of the Indian telecom market. India's government called discrimination claims "baseless," saying three satellite licensees (unnamed) still must meet security conditions; Starlink received a

government license last year. On Thursday Musk escalated by name:

"Starlink is licensed in over 165 countries and has spent five years complying with every single law and requirement of the government of India, so why still no license? Is Ambani the real boss of India?"

ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · POST

Rahul Gandhi quoted that post: "Welcome to India, Elon. Wait till you discover the other guy." Musk answered: "Thank you, Rahul. This is indeed troubling." He kept the consumer case in the open:

"Starlink provides Internet connectivity to the least-served, enabling self-education and prosperity by giving people access to sell their products worldwide!"

ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · [POST](#)

"People who oppose @Starlink hurt only the least-served. The wealthy or those living in large cities already have good Internet, so they don't understand."

ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · [POST](#)

Earlier he had written that Starlink in India would enable "high-speed, affordable Internet connectivity for those who can't afford current prices or who don't have a connection at all," and that it "will be of great help to areas of India that have had or no Internet and even no mobile coverage." On claims that militants used Starlink terminals inside India, he was flat: "Starlink beams are turned off over India, so the claim that they were used by anyone for any reason is absolutely false." He also told a user arguing for disaster resilience that "Starlink is often the only means of communication in natural disasters."

QUICK HIT

Coverage gaps, even in cities. Quoting a lawyer who said his village has had no mobile coverage "since Independence," Musk wrote that Starlink "can fill in the coverage gaps for those who most need it," noting that "no country has perfect coverage, including America." [post](#)

QUICK HIT

United Airlines Starlink. A passenger posted that free Starlink on a United transatlantic flight was "INCREDIBLE." Musk replied: "Hi Robin."

Starlink Mobile V2, Bangladesh, and airlines

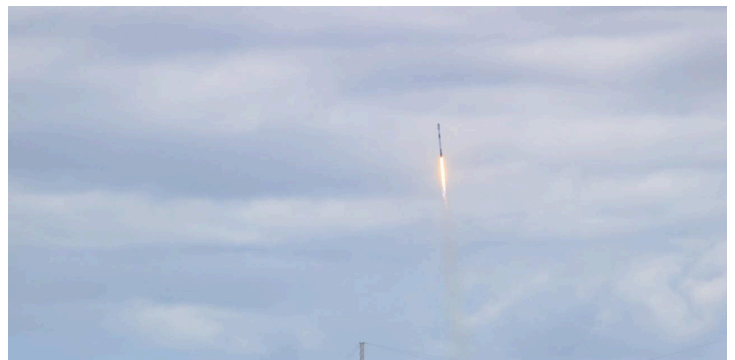
After the Federal Communications Commission (FCC) approved up to 15,000 very-low-orbit direct-to-device satellites on October 6—flying about 326 to 335 kilometers up, targeting roughly 150 megabits per second per user, with half of the constellation due by October 7, 2032 and the full build by October 7, 2035, per [Via Satellite](#)—Musk wrote:

"Starlink Mobile (direct-to-cell) V2 satellites are incredible. This @SpaceX constellation will enable more than 100 times the bandwidth of our current V1 system!"

ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · [POST](#)

SpaceX president Gwynne Shotwell told investors the next-generation mobile system with EchoStar spectrum could be "100 times better" than today's ~650 dedicated mobile satellites. Starlink announced Starlink Mobile with Banglalink in Bangladesh—messaging and location sharing on compatible phones in cellular dead zones—and SpaceX commercial lead Stephanie Bednarek said the service adds a layer of connectivity for coastal communities and travelers. Musk: "Connectivity leads to prosperity" and "Starlink connecting Bangladesh!"

KLM chief executive officer Marjan Rintel said free Starlink Wi-Fi will roll out on intercontinental flights from mid-2027 for Flying Blue members in all cabins, with the full wide-body fleet targeted by mid-2028, per [KLM's release](#). Musk amplified the announcement the same morning: ["Starlink coming to KLM!"](#)



A SpaceX Falcon 9 carrying Starlink satellites lifts off from Cape Canaveral Space Force Station on April 21, 2022, with Artemis I and a Crew Dragon Falcon visible on neighboring pads.

PHOTO: NASA/KIM SHIFLETT · PUBLIC DOMAIN

Crew-12 splashdown and a lunar mass-driver aside

On Wednesday Musk marked ["Dragon undocks from the Space Station"](#) after SpaceX confirmed separation. On Thursday morning EDT, Crew-12's Dragon splashed down in the Pacific west of Los Angeles; Musk quoted SpaceX's confirmation: ["Welcome home!"](#) On power for AI in space, he posted the cryptic "Perspicacious path to a petawatt/year," then told Aaron Burnett: "The path to a petawatt/year is mass drivers on the Moon."

A Shopify clerk, a fast Grok 4.8, and an open router

Musk spent much of the night selling Grok Bot as hireable labor—now able to run a store, watch X, and route hard work to whichever model is best.

Shopify, finance, and "hire an employee"

The official Grok Bot account said it can now check Shopify orders, track inventory, and update listings. Shopify posted a tip that users can ask the bot to add the connector in comments; Musk amplified both that tip and the product post:

"Hire Grok @Bot to manage your @Shopify store. He will do an amazing job!"

ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · [POST](#)

He added: "If you have a Grok Bot account, you can just add your @shopify connector by asking @Bot!" Quoting a how-to thread, he framed the product as labor:

"Grok @Bot is like hiring an extremely competent employee!"

ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · [POST](#)

He also quoted a user testimonial that Grok Bot can manage finances, said "It's really quite useful" with a phone download link, and marked Grok Bot 0.68.1's arrival—slide decks as PowerPoint or Google Slides, formatted email sends, and faster computer use on a 1920×1200 screen—with "Try the latest Grok @Bot!" When the official account said bots can now "search, read, and monitor X," he reshared it as "Grok x X." Asked about @mail.grokbots.com addresses, he replied that mail is "Going to wide release shortly."

Router wars and a lightning-fast Grok 4.8

Building on Tuesday's note that SpaceXAI will use the best backend—including Claude Opus 5.5, Midjourney, and Suno—Musk clarified the routing rule and the cheap-path plan:

"Grok @Bot will use whatever achieves the best outcome for users. Simple questions will route to small, fast models. Questions with complex answers will route to large models."

ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · [POST](#)

"However, most @Bot requests are pretty simple and will be handled by a lightning-fast version of Grok 4.8 when that comes out. Operating principle is to give Grok Bot users the best possible combination of speed & intelligence."

ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · [POST](#)

He congratulated Anthropic on Claude Haiku 5.5 ("Congrats on another great model!") and, when Aaron Levie of Box wrote that agent swarms will need "insane" compute plus computers, networking, and file systems, Musk replied: "People have no idea."

On why the agent buildout is still early

Aaron Levie (@levie): "The compute needed for the stage of AI we're about to enter is going to be insane... agents that review all of our code for security issues... background agents working on tasks 24/7." Musk's one-line reply: "People have no idea."

QUICK HIT

Paul Graham / Amazon agents. Graham wrote that Amazon banning shopping agents is "the first opportunity I've seen since Amazon was founded for a startup to create an Amazon competitor." Musk reshared it with one word: "Seriously." ([Paul Graham](#))

III · APPEARANCES & HONORS

National Medal of Science at the White House

Today's ceremony sits inside a broader "Science: A New Golden Age" summit that the White House says launches more than \$6 billion in new science initiatives.

Science: A New Golden Age

According to [CNBC](#) and [PBS NewsHour](#), President Donald Trump is awarding the National Medal of Science today to Elon Musk, Sergey Brin, Jensen Huang, and Lisa Su. Michael Dell and Satya Nadella receive the National Medal of Technology and Innovation. White House assistant press secretary Liz Huston said the recipients "are helping ensure America keeps leading the world in innovation." Trump remarks were expected around 1:30 p.m. EDT. Musk replied to congratulations with:

"Thank you on behalf of the amazing people of SpaceX, Tesla, Neuralink and Boring Company, without whom anything I have done would have been impossible"

ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · [POST](#)

The same summit's [White House fact sheet](#) describes more than \$6 billion across federal agencies, industry, academia, and philanthropy, including \$2.4 billion in "super intelligence" tools and compute credits for a Genesis Mission Consortium (NVIDIA \$1 billion, AMD \$500 million, OpenAI \$200 million,

and others). Office of Science and Technology Policy Director Michael Kratsios called it "the most transformative day for the American scientific enterprise since the reshaping of the Federal research ecosystem following World War II." No separate recipient citation text for Musk's medal had been posted as of early afternoon EDT.

ALSO AT THE SUMMIT

Space nuclear and quantum missions

The fact sheet says NASA and the Department of Energy solidified a partnership on space nuclear power, including a Space Reactor-1 craft aimed at Mars and Lunar Reactor-1 on the lunar surface, and that the Department of Energy set eight "Quantum Computing Priority Applications" for a \$215 million Quantum Genesis Q Competition.

QUICK HIT

Historical clips. Musk reshared a 2011 talk on reusable rockets ("2011") and a 2003 Stanford roadmap for SpaceX ("2003").

IV · INTERVIEWS & APPEARANCES

In the press and on the record

Where Musk's words and SpaceX milestones showed up in regular media and official releases.

White House — National Medal of Science Thursday, October 8, 2026
Ceremony at the "Science: A New Golden Age" summit. National Medal of Science: Elon Musk, Sergey Brin, Jensen Huang, Lisa Su. National Medal of Technology and Innovation: Michael Dell, Satya Nadella. [CNBC](#) · [PBS](#) · [White House fact sheet](#).

CNBC — Starlink India Wednesday–Thursday, October 7–8, 2026
Priyanka Salve reports Musk's posts accusing vested interests of blocking Starlink, quotes the "crime against the people of India" line, and carries New Delhi's "baseless and misconceived" reply on the regulatory process. [CNBC report](#)

KLM — free Starlink Wi-Fi Thursday, October 8, 2026
Marjan Rintel: "We are making a long-standing wish of our passengers a reality: fast, free Wi-Fi on intercontinental flights starting in mid-2027." Musk amplified the announcement the same morning. [KLM's release](#) · Musk's [amplification](#)

Via Satellite / FCC — Starlink Mobile V2 October 6–7, 2026
Authorization for 15,000 NGSO direct-to-device satellites in MSS and supplemental coverage spectrum, separate from the broadband constellation; Shotwell's "100 times better" line to investors; V2 flights slated to start next year. [Via Satellite report](#)

Takeaways

1

Starlink's India standoff is now a named fight with Mukesh Ambani, not just "oligarchs."

2

Direct-to-cell V2 plus airline Wi-Fi are the commercial proof points Musk wants next to the India story.

3

Grok Bot is being sold as labor—stores, email, decks, finance—not as a chat toy.

4

Routing to Claude and others is official; a fast Grok 4.8 is the cost/speed answer for simple asks.

5

The White House medal lands inside a \$6 billion science-summit day; Musk did not give a long-form interview alongside it.

Sources

X posts by @elonmusk · [CNBC](#) · [PBS NewsHour](#) · [White House](#) · [KLM](#) · [Via Satellite](#) · [SpaceX](#) / [Starlink](#) · [Paul Graham](#) · [NASA Crew-12](#) splashdown reports

The Elon Gazette is compiled from public posts on X and published reporting. Quotes are reproduced verbatim unless marked as translated or paraphrased.